

Creating a diverse workplace with authentic multicultural voices; how can we create real long-term equality?

Dr. Patricia G.
Beckmann-Wells
Director, Bunsella Studios, Professor,
Irvine Valley College
pbeckmann@ivc.edu

Sonya Carey
Producer, Industrial Brothers
theanimationlounge@gmail.com

Magdiela H. Duhamel
Production Manager, Nickelodeon
Animation
magdielaaduhamel@gmail.com

Dr. Linc Johnson
Professor, Los Angeles Community
College District
drlincj@alumni.usc.edu

Dr. Margaret Martin
Social Impact Fellow, Singularity
University
margaretmartin08@gmail.com

ABSTRACT

Computer graphics media industries see themselves as forward thinking and inclusive. However, BIPOC (black, Indigenous and people of color) are often not at the table when issues regarding inclusion are discussed. Inclusion requires a plan that reaches not only the candidate, but the educational and home communities a candidate is from. This panel will discuss the experience of BIPOC artists entering a predominantly white male workforce and what change must occur to make the journey a little better for everyone.

Filmmakers, artists, and educators comprise this panel and will represent the barriers experienced by persons of color that occur not just at the interview, but in the educational system and BIPOC community. They will share experiences on production and give honest feedback on how to create positive change.

KEYWORDS

Equality, Human Resources, Fair workplace, workplace, diversity, inclusive

ACM Reference Format:

Dr. Patricia G. Beckmann-Wells, Sonya Carey, Magdiela H. Duhamel, Dr. Linc Johnson, and Dr. Margaret Martin. 2021. Creating a diverse workplace with authentic multicultural voices; how can we create real long-term equality?. In *Special Interest Group on Computer Graphics and Interactive Techniques Conference (SIGGRAPH '21 Panels)*, August 09–13, 2021, Virtual Event, USA. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 2 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3450617.3464489>

1 BIOGRAPHIES

Panelist: Dr. Lincoln Johnson. Education professional with EdD in Educational Leadership from USC with a concentration in Higher Education Leadership. Professor with the Los Angeles Community College System, and former supervisor of correctional education

programs at the California Department of Corrections and Rehabilitation. Mentor to many young black men seeking opportunity.

Panelist: Sonya Carey. After moving to Los Angeles, California, USA, and taking a personal interest in animation, Sonya landed her first job, as a compositor on the Ren and Stimpy show. Within just a few years, the paperless 2D animation technology exploded and Nelvana, Toronto's Premiere Animation studio announced its new 2D digital division. Sonya took that opportunity to return to Toronto and was hired in the composting department. Now, after 25 years of experience in the animation industry as an artist and Producer, Sonya is sharing her knowledge through teaching.

Panelist: Magdiela Duhamel. Throughout her career at various studios (FX Networks, DreamWorks Animation, Marvel Studios, Warner Brothers Animation, FOX,) she has contributed to multiple projects that include "Trollhunters: Tales of Arcadia", "Dragons: Race to the Edge", "Rocky & Bullwinkle" and Marvel Studio's first animated series, "What If...?". She is currently the Production Manager for Nickelodeon's The Casagrandes. Magdiela founded LatinX in Animation, a non-profit organization under the Latino Film Institute created to build a community for Latinx professionals that work in different roles throughout Animation, VFX, and Gaming industries. She serves as its CoDirector, connecting new and experienced professionals in the entertainment industry.

Panelist: Dr. Margaret Martin. Margaret Martin is a doctor of public health and founder of Harmony Project (www.harmony-project.org). Since 2001, Harmony Project has used intensive music training to engage, challenge and mentor children with few resources from early childhood through high school graduation. Harmony Project provides instruments, tuition-free group and private music lessons, ensemble participation and mentoring to thousands of the most vulnerable children in Los Angeles, boosting confidence, connection, literacy, school achievement and participation in higher education. Students participate in full-time bands and orchestras 4 to 10 hours per week, year-round throughout childhood. Harmony Project and Dr. Martin have garnered multiple national awards, most notably from the Obama White House, the U.S. Department of Education and the Academic Pediatric Association, for work that improves the health and well-being of children.

Dr. Martin advises a growing national network of affiliated programs. She works with school systems, cities, and youth-serving organizations throughout the country to help them integrate her

Permission to make digital or hard copies of part or all of this work for personal or classroom use is granted without fee provided that copies are not made or distributed for profit or commercial advantage and that copies bear this notice and the full citation on the first page. Copyrights for third-party components of this work must be honored. For all other uses, contact the owner/author(s).

SIGGRAPH '21 Panels, August 09–13, 2021, Virtual Event, USA

© 2021 Copyright held by the owner/author(s).

ACM ISBN 978-1-4503-8370-7/21/08.

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3450617.3464489>

scientifically validated model of after school music-based mentoring. Research with students in Los Angeles by a team from Northwestern University's Auditory Neuroscience Lab showed that participating students from low-income families significantly improved cognitive function and literacy, compared with non-participating controls. (See: <http://www.brainvolts.northwestern.edu/neuroeducation>) School districts that have adopted after school music-based mentoring have seen significant improvement in reading and math achievement for participating students. Importantly, the greatest gains have been seen in participating students with the lowest prior levels of achievement in English Language Arts and Math.

Host: Dr. Pat Beckmann Wells. Dr. Pat Beckmann Wells, EdD., co authored 'Face It! A visual reference for multi-ethnic modeling' with Scott Wells (Treyarch), in response to the adoption of their

multi-ethnic son to encourage character artists to inform character designs with forensic research. Pat and Scott speak at media production studios, most recently Pixar.

Pat created and produced the 'FJORG!' animation marathon over four years with SIGGRAPH, bridging over 150 talented graduates from around the world to industry.

Her films were featured in over 280 festivals internationally: Slamdance, Lunafest, and the Los Angeles County Museum of Art, among others. She is currently working on her first feature film which recently has been awarded prize funding. She is currently a tenured professor at Irvine Valley College leading the Interactive Media Art program.

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

American for the Arts: 10 Arts education fast facts. <https://www.americansforthearts.org/by-topic/arts-education/10-arts-education-fast-facts>.